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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

7018 add-on

DECLASSIFIED
PER E.O. 13526

2009-1032-MR
SS 7/11/14

MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Meeting with John Major of the United Kingdom (U)

PARTICIPANTS: U.S.
The President
James A. Baker, III, Secretary of State
John H. Sununu, Chief of Staff
Brent Scowcroft, Assistant to the President
for National Security Affairs
Marlin Fitzwater, Assistant to the President
and Press Secretary
Robert M. Gates, Assistant to the President
and Deputy for National Security Affairs
Robert D. Blackwill, Senior Director,
European and Soviet Affairs, NSC Staff
(Notetaker)
Raymond Seitz, Assistant Secretary of State

United Kingdom
John Major, Foreign Secretary
Sir Antony Acland, Ambassador to the U.S.
Sir Patrick Wright, Permanent Undersecretary
Stephen Wall, Private Secretary
Andrew Burns, Press Secretary

DATE, TIME September 11, 1989, 10:00 a.m. - 10:35 a.m.
AND PLACE: Oval Office

The President welcomed the Foreign Secretary and hoped that he would have a good discussion later in the day with Secretary Baker. The President felt the U.S. and the U.K. were together on most issues. He had talked to Prime Minister Thatcher and they were in agreement on Poland, the anti-drug effort, and what the G-7 might do regarding Columbia. The only difficulty was in the Alliance's failure to meet its September 7 deadline for tabling the remainder of its new proposal in the CFE negotiations. That had caused the President some grief. The Allies need to move this matter forward. NATO must keep momentum and not signal a loss of interest. (§)

The Foreign Secretary thought the obstacles within the Alliance on CFE could be overcome and that he and Secretary Baker could make progress later in the day. He hoped there would be no undue

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delay. The Foreign Secretary felt the President understood London's concerns about non-circumvention; the new U.S. language was very helpful. (Ø)

The Foreign Secretary added that, as the President knew, the Prime Minister hoped to come to the United States as soon after the opening of Parliament on November 14 as could be arranged. (Ø)

The President said he hoped for an informal session with the Prime Minister on a wide array of issues. (Ø)

The Prime Minister would like that, the Foreign Secretary replied. She has Gorbachev on her mind, he said, in quite a big way. On drugs, the President's initiative is going down very well in the United Kingdom. The U.K. had its own team in Bogota last week and London wanted to help. The British government would also be pushing its European partners for more involvement. (Ø)

The President asked if the British sensed that Barco was going to last the course. (Ø)

The Foreign Secretary said yes. Barco has made clear his determination to stand up to a bunch of hoodlums. (Ø)

On Poland, the Foreign Secretary said the U.S. and the U.K. shared the same objectives. The Poles need a proper IMF agreement. The West should not smother them with so much help that they do not take the necessary steps. The British government was also wondering what Gorbachev's real goals are in Eastern Europe. The Foreign Secretary said he did not know. (Ø)

The President said that Prime Thatcher would have a chance to look into this question when she was in Moscow on September 23rd. Congress had discovered Poland and pressure was building on the Hill. The U.S. might be able to do more on food aid, but the West should be sure it was not throwing money at the problem without the needed structural reforms in Poland. (Ø)

Secretary Baker asked if the British government was on board for Paris Club rescheduling before an IMF agreement. (Ø)

The Foreign Secretary said his Treasury Department would prefer an IMF agreement first. (Ø)

The President asked if Boris Yeltsin would be visiting the U.K. (Ø)

Not yet, the Foreign Secretary said. Continuing, he noted that there were a couple of problems of special concern to the Prime Minister. First among these was Hong Kong and the Vietnamese boat people. This issue had taken an immense amount of the Foreign Secretary's time. On Hong Kong, London knew where it wanted to go,

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but was not sure about how to get there. There were no signs of panic in Hong Kong, but much less confidence than before June. The Chinese leadership was now being uncooperative about Hong Kong and the modalities that still need to be negotiated. (S)

The President asked about what had happened in the Hong Kong market. (S)

The Foreign Secretary said the market had survived remarkably well. This was a mixed blessing, because the Chinese asked how the British could cite a loss of confidence when the stock market was doing so well. Still, it would be quite a job to restore the confidence of the population of Hong Kong. (S)

The President asked if the Foreign Secretary was under pressure to be tougher on the Chinese. (S)

The Foreign Secretary said the British government was happy to stay where it was for the time being. (S)

The President noted that there could be further surprises in China; the West needed to be prudent. U.S. domestic pressure was manageable now, but could increase from both the left and the right, and the Chinese were increasingly blaming the U.S. for their problems. (S)

Secretary Baker asked what sort of contacts the British had through their Embassy in Beijing. (S)

Low level, the Foreign Secretary replied. The situation was pretty much a standoff at the moment. Continuing, the Foreign Secretary noted that when the President saw the Prime Minister he had touched on the problem of intelligence, cooperation, and the need to improve it. London had a package which would be given to Judge Webster in October. (S)

The President asked if the Foreign Secretary had any brilliant ideas on how to solve the Lebanon problem. (S)

The Foreign Secretary said that some people were concerned about the U.S. taking its diplomats out because the Syrians might be further emboldened and increase their military effort, and because some might conclude the U.S. had given up. The U.K. was grateful for the U.S. offer to take out British diplomats at the time of the American evacuation, but the British officials were under no unusual threat. The Western nations should try to reduce the degree of shelling, even if they could not stop it entirely. (S)

The President said the U.S. took its people out because this crazy, Aoun, was threatening them. (S)

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The Foreign Secretary commented that moderates in Amal would want the U.S. to return its Embassy as soon as possible. (Ø)

The President said he hoped to do that. The situation was so complicated, and so sad. Did the U.K. have any representation in Syria? (Ø)

Permanent Undersecretary Wright said it was only an interest section, a very small operation. (Ø)

The Foreign Secretary wondered how much longer the Palestinian problem could remain static. (Ø)

The President remarked that the only game in town is elections in the occupied territories, but he was pessimistic. (Ø)

The Foreign Secretary asked if Shamir was willing to make concessions. (Ø)

Secretary Baker said that would only be known when there are face to face negotiations. Shamir's willingness could not be tested before that point. (Ø)

The President said the situation was discouraging. (Ø)

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6519 Add-on

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

September 20, 1989

FILE

INFORMATION

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER, 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 9/8/25

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: ROBERT D. BLACKWILL *RB*
FROM: BARRY F. LOWENKRON *BL*
SUBJECT: Your Meeting With Finnish Foreign Minister Pertti
Paasio, Thursday, September 21, 3:30-4:00 p.m.

Foreign Minister Paasio is in Washington to commemorate the 70th anniversary of US-Finnish diplomatic relations. In addition to seeing you, Paasio will be meeting with Deputy Secretary Eagleburger, Senator Pell, Congressman Hamilton, and the Secretary General of the OAS. Paasio will be delivering a personal letter from President Koivisto to the President outlining his views on the changes underway in Europe.

East-West Relations. Gorbachev may visit Finland later this year. Paasio will be interested in hearing your thoughts on the Baker-Shevardnadze Ministerial, as well as prospects for a possible US-Summit. You might emphasize our intention to move the arms control process forward through discussions of the President's START verification and confidence building package, recent breakthroughs toward agreement on a verification package for a nuclear testing accord, and possible movement on a chemical weapons ban. Paasio may also ask about the CFE talks, reiterating Finnish concerns about flank security.

Soviet Reform. Paasio may ask you for your assessment of Gorbachev's internal reform and political standing. This summer President Koivisto called for an end to press articles on the need for Finland to "join the bandwagon" and redefine its relationship with Moscow, in particular modifying the 1948 Treaty of Friendship with the Soviet Union.

The Finns are particularly concerned about developments in the Baltics, fearful of a massive refugee outflow in the event of trouble in the region. Secretary Baker's comment that he would discuss the Baltics with the Soviets caught the attention of Finnish officials. You might reiterate our commitment to peaceful change, and our intention not to exacerbate reform efforts in the Soviet Union or Eastern Europe.

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Aid to Eastern Europe. The Finns are part of the G-24 looking at ways to provide economic assistance to Poland and Hungary. You might tell Paasio of Administration efforts to help the Mazowiecki government, in step with the G-24 process.

EC-92. Finland is concerned about the negative economic repercussions to the EFTA countries resulting from EC-92. (Finnish trade with the Soviets have steadily declined over the past twenty years, in favor of the OECD countries.) Last May enroute to Moscow, Secretary Baker told Finnish officials in Helsinki that the US would be willing to consult with EFTA members on EC-92. (The effort is being coordinated by the Assistant Secretary for Economic Affairs at State. An EFTA-EC Ministerial is planned for December.) Paasio will be interested in having your thoughts on how the Administration views growing European unity.

Regional Issues. (If Raised) According to officials at the Finnish embassy, Paasio will tell the OAS (where Finland has observer status) that Finland will contribute \$100,000 toward monitoring the elections in Nicaragua. If Paasio raises this in his meeting with you, a pat on the back would be appropriate. On Southern Africa, the Finns should also be thanked for providing a battalion for UNTAG.

John Gordon
John Gordon concurs.

Attachment
Tab I Biography

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
23b. Report	Government Report (1 pp.)	8/10/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: September 1989 [3]

Date Closed: 5/11/2011	OA/ID Number: 30500-003
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
AR Disposition Date:	MR Disposition Date:

RESTRICTION CODES

Presidential Records Act - [44 U.S.C. 2204(a)]

P-1 National Security Classified Information [(a)(1) of the PRA]
P-2 Relating to the appointment to Federal office [(a)(2) of the PRA]
P-3 Release would violate a Federal statute [(a)(3) of the PRA]
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C. Closed in accordance with restrictions contained in donor's deed of gift.

PRM. Removed as a personal record misfile.

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
24a. Memorandum	To: Brent Scowcroft/Robert Gates From: Robert Blackwill Re: Attached Study (1 pp.)	9/20/89	(b)(1)	

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: September 1989 [3]

Date Closed: 5/11/2011	OA/ID Number: 30500-003
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
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Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
24b. Paper	Poland (3 pp.)	9/20/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: September 1989 [3]

Date Closed:	5/11/2011	OA/ID Number:	30500-003
FOIA/SYS Case #:	2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:	
Re-review Case #:		Appeal Disposition:	
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:		Disposition Date:	
AR Case #:		MR Case #:	
AR Disposition:		MR Disposition:	
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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20508

7384

Barry - We will need
quick readout. September 19, 1989

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: ROBERT D. BLACKWILL/VIRGINIA LAMPLEY
FROM: BARRY F. LOWENKRON
SUBJECT: Your Meeting With Senator Dole, Wednesday,
September 20, 1989, 5:30 p.m.

Senator Dole is following up on his telephone conversation with you last week on the Armenian genocide resolution issue. As we understand it, the Senator is trying to effect a compromise that would satisfy the Armenian community without upsetting Turkish sensibilities. We doubt such a compromise is possible. The Congress is littered with past attempts to broker a deal between both sides. The Armenians insist on the word "Genocide." The Turks adamantly oppose any resolution.

In March 1987 the Reagan Administration signed a letter extending our DECA agreement with Turkey. In that letter we agreed to, "vigorously oppose inappropriate actions which would be harmful to healthy U.S.-Turkish relations..." Both sides agreed that such actions included reduced aid levels, 7/10 ratio language, and Armenian Genocide resolutions. It took two years for this letter to be negotiated. (Hence the clock on our DECA five year extension actually began in 1985. The current DECA will be subject to renewal in December 1990.)

We recommend that you continue your attempts to dissuade Senator Dole from sponsoring an Armenian resolution, making the point once again that any such resolution would be damaging to our relations with Turkey and would undermine our strategic interests along NATO's southern flank. We hope that, if a resolution is introduced, it will be sponsored by another senator who will not carry the same weight as Senator Dole, increasing the odds of having it defeated.

Bob Hutchings concurs.

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PER NSC WAIVER, 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 9/18/25

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Attachments

Tab A Senator Dole's letter
Tab B Resolution

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5445

United States Senate

OFFICE OF THE REPUBLICAN LEADER

WASHINGTON DC 20510

June 28, 1989

The President
The White House
Washington

Dear Mr. President:

In the past, you have spoken eloquently about the need for our Government to acknowledge the terrible wrongs committed against the Armenian population of the Ottoman Empire during the period of 1915-1923. As a result, many Armenian-Americans and many of us who have been sympathetic to their desire to have this terrible chapter in history appropriately acknowledged were hopeful that this Administration would reverse the position of previous Administrations, in adamantly opposing any expression of acknowledgment by Congress or the Executive Branch.

Regrettably, there is no sign that the State Department, at least, has changed its position at all. Indeed, recent attempts by Armenian-American groups to urge the State Department to address this issue with an open mind have been rebuffed with language that can only be termed "bureaucratic stone-walling."

I am very sensitive to the importance of U.S.-Turkish relations, and understand we must be very careful to insure that our actions on this issue do not disrupt this important Alliance relationship. At the same time, I am convinced that people of good will -- in the Armenian-American community, in the Administration, and in the Turkish Government -- can find some way to do what is right, without creating an Executive-Congressional confrontation or damaging U.S.-Turkish relations.

To that end, I would welcome a discussion of this issue with you, or other appropriate Administration officials. I look forward to hearing from you on this matter at your convenience.

Sincerely yours,



BOB DOLE
United States Senate

JOINT RESOLUTION

Designating April 24, 1989, as "National Day of Remembrance
of the Armenian Genocide of 1915-1923".

1 *Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives*
2 *of the United States of America in Congress assembled,*
3 That April 24, 1989, is designated as "National Day of Re-
4 membrance of the Armenian Genocide of 1915-1923", and
5 the President is authorized and requested to issue a procla-
6 mation calling upon the people of the United States to ob-
7 serve this date as a day of remembrance for the 1.5 million
8 people of Armenian ancestry who were victims of the geno-
9 cide perpetrated by the governments of the Ottoman Empire
10 from 1915 to 1923, prior to the establishment of the Repub-

2

1 lic of Turkey, and in their memory this date is commemorat-
2 ed by all Armenians and their friends throughout the world.

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Chron
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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

September 19, 1989

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: ROBERT D. BLACKWILL *RB*
FROM: ROBERT L. HUTCHINGS *RLH*
SUBJECT: Your Meeting with Werner Weidenfeld, FRG
Coordinator for German-American Relations,
September 20, 11:30 a.m.

Weidenfeld, a close Kohl confidant (therefore viewed with suspicion by Foreign Ministry officials), is in Washington for a series of academic and German-American events. His official calls are mainly at USIA and on the Hill.

One issue that may arise is the naming of a U.S. counterpart for Weidenfeld. USIA Director Wick performed the function in the last Administration, and we are pushing State to recommend a successor, presumably Bruce Gelb. We would hope to make the announcement in early October in conjunction with German-American Day.

Weidenfeld has no specific agenda. He will be worth sounding out on Kohl's position and on the state of our bilateral relations, particularly in the educational and cultural fields. With his professorial bent (and title), he will want to compare notes on the major European and East-West issues.

Weidenfeld will be accompanied by Ambassador Ruhfus and an Embassy notetaker.

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER, 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 9/18/25

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
27a. Memorandum	To: Brent Scowcroft From: Robert Blackwill Re: Strategy (3 pp.)	9/19/89	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
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(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
27b. Paper	Key Elements of a Successful US Program (3 pp.)	n.d.	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: September 1989 [3]

Date Closed: 5/11/2011	OA/ID Number: 30500-003
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#7353

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF DEFENSE
THE EXECUTIVE SECRETARY

18 SEP 1989

MEMORANDUM FOR EXECUTIVE SECRETARY
NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
GROUND FLOOR, WEST WING
~~THE WHITE HOUSE~~

SUBJECT: Draft SECDEF Remarks for
Review and Comments

The attached draft remarks were prepared
for Secretary Cheney's speech to the
Commonwealth Club of San Francisco,
20 September 1989.

Request that you review and telephone
any comments you might have to Jeff
Salmon, (697-8191) by Noon, Tuesday,
September 20, 1989.

NOTE: P. 6-17 IS PREVIOUS CLEARED MATERIAL


George F. Cole Jr.
Colonel, USAF
Executive Secretary

Attachment

9/19/89
1257

Brent -- This is a tough
speech on Soviet military power,
including that perestroika could
enhance Soviet offensive capability.
This speech will make the
Thursday morning papers, just
before Shevardnadze's meeting
with the President. Not ideal
timing. Your reaction?
BDS Blackwill

Originally Processed With FOIA(s):
2011-0002-F

FOIA Number:
2011-0002-F

FOIA MARKER

**This is not a textual record. This is used as an
administrative marker by the George Bush Presidential
Library Staff.**

Record Group/Collection: George H.W. Bush Presidential Records
Collection/Office of Origin: National Security Council
Series: European and Eurasian Directorate
Subseries: Central Chronological Files

OA/ID Number: 30500
Folder ID Number: 30500-003

Folder Title:
September 1989 [3]

Stack:	Row:	Section:	Shelf:	Position:
V	0	0	0	0
